

42088 – Industrial Project

Project Status Report

Milestone 3 – Construction I

Project name:	Automatic, universal push-button actuator, equipped with force gauge
Customer:	Altice Labs
Customer supervisor:	Eng. Hélder Alves Eng. Nuno Balseiro
Date issued:	27/11/2024
Team members:	<u>Coordinator:</u> Cláudia Almeida, claudiasalmeida@ua.pt , 914102617. <u>Other team members:</u> Rafael Alves, rafael01@ua.pt , 937353627. Gonçalo Peralta, goncaloperalta@ua.pt , 916828627. Pedro Matias, pedrodsmatias@ua.pt , 917126548.
Supervisor:	Professor Pedro Fonseca
Class supervisor:	Professor Pedro Fonseca

Management summary:

The project is on track to meet its delivery deadlines. The team has successfully completed the elaboration phase and is now transitioning into the construction phase of the project. At this stage, all of the necessary hardware components have been delivered. The PCBs required to power and control the actuator have been thoroughly designed and reviewed multiple times with guidance and feedback from both class and customer supervisor. Additionally, the first draft of the user interface was presented using simulated data to demonstrate functionality. Feedback was collected during this phase, and improvements are being incorporated to refine the interface for its next iteration.

As we move forward, our focus will shift to establishing communication with the Raspberry Pi, generating test data, processing feedback signals from the test gateway and start individual tests on main components such as the actuator and the force sensor. Meanwhile, we await the printing of the PCBs, after which we will proceed with assembling and soldering all the components. This marks an exciting and critical step in bringing the system closer to full functionality.

Considering all the progress and development to date, as well as the organization of future tasks, the team anticipates that all proposed objectives will be successfully achieved.

Architecture

The architecture of the system consists of three main components: the **Control Unit**, the **Control Electric Circuit**, and the **Mechanical Actuation**.

- The **Control unit** is managed by a Raspberry Pi that runs the control software and serves as the central processing component for the system. The Raspberry Pi generates a PWM (Pulse Width Modulation) signal to regulate the actuator's movement, allowing for controlled button pressing with variable force. It also maintains a Secure Shell (SSH) connection with the DUT, allowing it to detect feedback from the device in real time, such as system responses or status changes upon a button click. For force measurement, the Raspberry Pi reads data from the force sensor using I2C/SPI protocols, ensuring accurate and timely data transfer from the sensor to the control software.
- The **Control electric circuit** amplifies the PWM signal generated by the Raspberry Pi, ensuring sufficient power is supplied to the actuator. This circuit includes an **H-Bridge**, allowing current to flow in both directions as required to control the actuator's movement accurately. The circuit, powered by a 12V, 3A DC power source, will provide the energy needed to drive the actuator with stability and precision, allowing for both pressing and releasing movements, required for testing various types of buttons.
- The **Mechanical Actuation** assembly is designed to interface directly with the DUT, positioning the actuator over the buttons to be tested. This component includes a clamp that securely attaches to the DUT, providing flexibility and adaptability for different button placements and device sizes. Mounted within the clamp is a linear actuator that performs the physical pressing of the buttons, with a force sensor placed behind the actuator to capture the exact force applied during each press. This assembly connects to a PCB board, which relays signals from the force sensor back to the Control Unit, ensuring accurate control and data capture throughout the testing process.

Figure 1 shows the improved and updated mechanical design of the product.

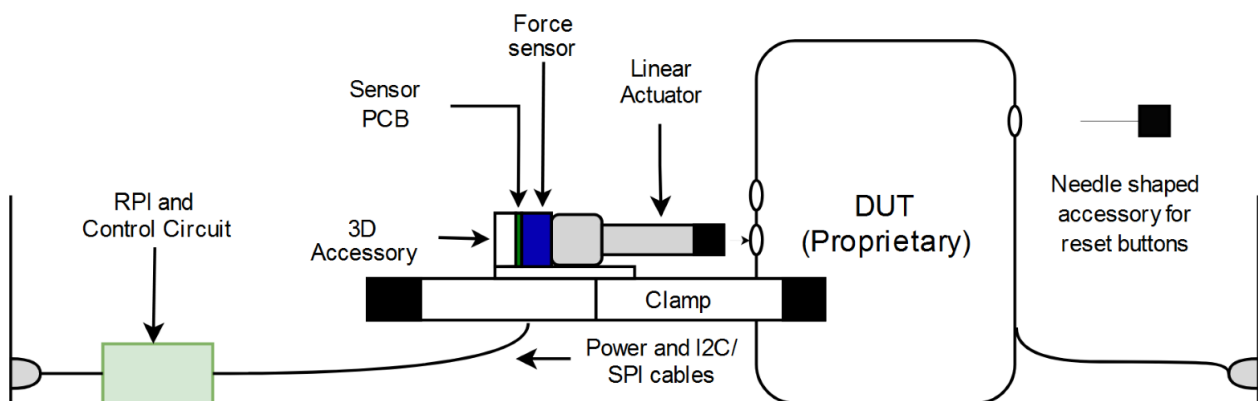
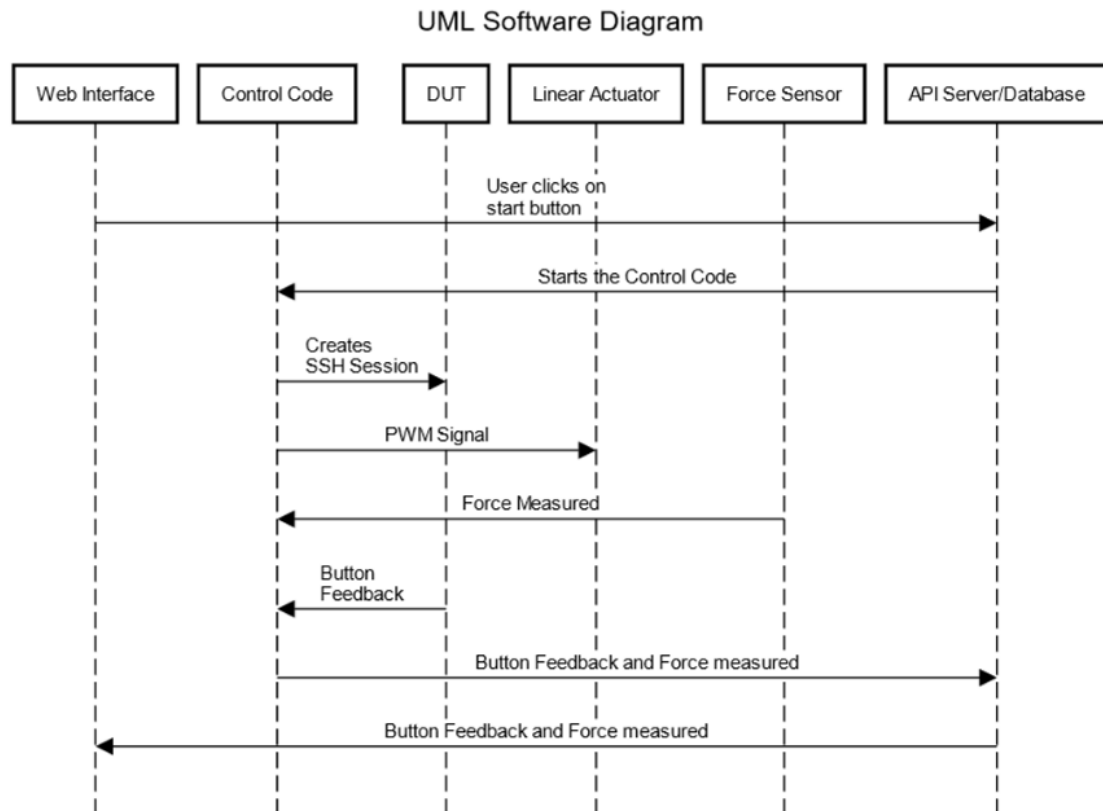


Figure 1. Mechanical assembly of the product.

Figure 2 shows the Unified Modelling Language (UML) Sequence Diagram, which represents the interaction amongst the different components of the system.

Figure 2. UML Diagram.



Further details on the system’s architecture can be found in the attached document “BlockDiagrams”.

Key milestones

ID	Description	Original planned completion date	Current planned completion date	Actual completion date
Software Web Interface	Suggested visual presentation of the web interface	13/11/2024	13/11/2024	14/11/2024
Hardware PCB’s design	Design of the system's printed circuits and electrical circuits	13/11/2024	18/11/2024	21/11/2024
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Communication with Raspberry Pi	Generate test signals and process feedback signals from the DUT.	04/12/2024	04/12/2024	27/11/2024
Design of the mechanical attachment	Development of the mechanical couple using 3D print.	04/12/2024	04/12/2024	--/--/--
Individual tests to the main components	Functionality tests for the main components of the project: force sensor and linear actuator.	04/12/2024	04/12/2024	--/--/--

Progress and deviation from plan

The development of the PCBs required extra effort to reach a level deemed suitable for the prototyping stage. This additional effort caused a small delay in finalizing the design, leading to a late printing order and, consequently, a significant portion of the testing will be delayed, temporarily stalling progress on the hardware side. To mitigate this deviation, the team will redirect their time to other tasks in two primary fronts: the first one being establishing communication with the Raspberry Pi, generating test data, and processing feedback signals from the test gateway, and the second one consisting on the designing of the mechanical attachment, to be developed using 3D printing.

Work plan for next iteration

For the next iteration, individual tests on the actuator will be carried out. Additionally, the team will begin analysing and looking into the gateway's feedback signals through given credentials to access its operating system.

Table 2 shows the sprint plan updated.

Sprints	Weeks	Tasks		Claúdia	Rafael	Pedro	Gonçalo
		Detailed system architecture and list of components finalized		x	x	x	x
1	4	PCB design for the control signal and the Force Sensor	Web page development and structurization of a control code on the Rpi	x	x	x	x
MVP's		Web page interface and all PCB's		We are currently here			
		Prototype a 3D support	Test basic Actuator control and SSH connection to the gateway with the RPi	x	x	x	x
2	3	Test the force sensor PCB	Test the controller PCB	x	x	x	x
		Merge everthing into a single control code		x	x	x	x
3	3	Develop a 3D model to support the architecture	Update the interface to match the control code	x	x	x	x
		Test the overall architecture		x	x	x	x
4	2	Collecting final feedback before final construction		x	x	x	x
		Delivery of the prototype to the client		x	x	x	x

Figure 3. Sprint plan

Financial status

With respect to the project budget and components list, no modifications have been made since the previous milestone. Consequently, the order was placed as planned, and all required components have now been successfully delivered.

Quantity	Description		Status	Price Per Unite(€)	Total Value(€)	%
1	Honeywell FMAMSDXX015WC2C3	Force Sensor	Purchased	33,67	33,67	18%
1	Actuonix L12-50-50-12-S	Actuator	Purchased	83,66	83,66	45%
2	JST Comercial RE-H022TD-1190	Actuator connector to PCB	Purchased	0,18	0,36	0%
1	CUI Inc. SMM30-12-K-P6	Power Supplier	Purchased	17,76	17,76	10%
1	Same Sky PJ-079BH	Connector to Power Supplier	Purchased	1,5	1,5	1%
1	Raspberry Pi 4 B	Processing Unit	Purchased	32,55	32,55	17%
1	ST L6205D	Controler for the actuator	Purchased	6,12	6,12	3%
1	Nichicon GYF1H101MCQ1GS	Capacitor	Purchased	1,11	1,11	1%
1	KYOCERA AVX KAM21BR71H104JT	Capacitor	Purchased	0,19	0,19	0%
1	TAIYO YUDEN MAASU21GSB7224KTCA01	Bootstrap Capacitor	Purchased	0,4	0,4	0%
1	KYOCERA AVX KGF15AR71H103KT	Bootstrap Capacitor	Purchased	0,23	0,23	0%
2	KYOCERA AVX 12065A562FAT2A	Capacitor	Purchased	0,94	1,88	1%
2	onsemi / Fairchild 1N4148	Bootstrap Diode	Purchased	0,09	0,18	0%
2	Panasonic ERA-8VRB1003V	Resistor	Purchased	1,18	2,36	1%
1	Vishay CRCW2010100RJNEFIF	Bootstrap Resistor	Purchased	0,55	0,55	0%
1	TI INA381A3	Current Amplifier	Purchased	1,1	1,1	1%
1	TE Connectivity RLC73K2ER162FTDF	Current Measuring Resistor	Purchased	0,46	0,46	0%
1	Vishay MCS0402MD1002BE100	Pull-Up Resistor	Purchased	0,45	0,45	0%
1	CTS Electronic Components 14TR08SA103CP	Potentiometer	Purchased	0,71	0,71	0%
1	TI TLV9032QDGKRQ1	Capacitor	Purchased	1,5	1,5	1%
1	KYOCERA AVX KAM21BR71H104JT	Capacitor	Purchased	0,19	0,19	0%
				Total:	186,93	100%

Figure 4. Updated project budget and final components table.

Group contribution

Group member	Major contributions	Work share (%)
Cláudia Almeida	Team coordinator, responsible for organizing regrouping sessions and managing communication with external parties. Primary editor of written documents, developed the use cases, studied market relevance for industrial automation, and led Milestone 1 presentation. Web interface Development.	25
Rafael Alves	Developed the final hardware components list, analysed project risks for each phase and proposed mitigation strategies, and led Milestone 1 presentation. Development of the PCB.	25
Gonçalo Peralta	Created all system diagrams and drafts of the mechanical product for documentation, developed the block diagrams and use cases, sprints spread calendar and led the initial planning for the software approach to the project. Web interface Development.	25
Pedro Matias	Contributed to researching and finalizing the hardware components list and supported the assessment of technical needs for project phases. Development of the PCB.	25

Comments and remarks

Attached are the documents relating to the risk analysis of the project and the block diagrams of the system broken down into various levels.